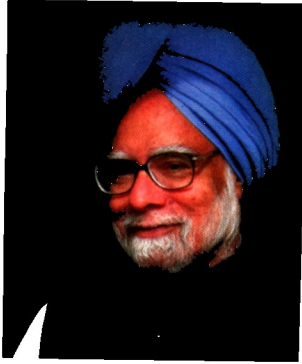




DR. MANMOHAN SINGH
Hon'ble Prime Minister

NAT NAL ANGA RIVER BASIN AUTHORITY

**A new initiative of the
Ministry of Environment and
Forests for cleaning the Ganga**

To meet the formidable challenge of cleaning the Ganga river, the Central Government has launched a new initiative and established the National Ganga River Basin Authority. The river basin will now be the unit of planning. The emphasis will henceforth be on ensuring minimum ecological flows in addition to pollution abatement.

GANGA : A Unique River

The Ganga basin represents 26 percent of the Indian landmass. The uniqueness of the Ganga gives it a standing not ascribed to any other river in the country. The national importance of the Ganga comes from reasons that are geographical, historical, socio-culture and economic.

The ever increasing threat to the river is due to rapid industrialisation and urbanisation leading to an unrelenting discharge of untreated wastewater into the river. The problem is compounded by inadequate flows. The launching of the Ganga Action Plan as a centrally funded scheme in 1985 was the beginning of the river cleaning program.

A NEW MISSION

The need for revamping the Ganga cleaning program was being widely recognised. Accordingly, the Central Government has given Ganga the status of a 'National River' and has constituted a 'National Ganga River Basin Authority' (NGRBA) on 20.02.2009.

The NGRBA is an empowered planning, financing, monitoring and coordinating authority for the Ganga River. It has been set up under Section 3(3) of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986. The objective is to have river basin as the unit of planning and to have a comprehensive response covering water quality and flow, sustainable access, environment management, prevention and control of pollution and food and energy security, in the form of a national mission.

